Summer ~~Winter~~ 2026 Substitute Player Process

Updated ***3/9/26*** ~~11/11/25~~

The purpose of the Substitute Player Process is to ***allow teams to replace injured or unavailable players which will help them maintain competitive integrity while preventing them from gaining an unfair advantage*** ~~protect against a team *consistently* improving~~ through the selection of subs. A team should be at its most competitive point with ~~all~~ their original drafted players. Specific rules governing the substitution process can ***also*** be found in Division 1 Rules. ~~The process is not designed to make it difficult for managers to obtain subs.~~

"Sub-Only" players will be finalized after the draft. *No player will be allowed to sign up as a SUB–ONLY player after the deadline to apply to play in Division 1 each season, other than a player coming to Division 1 out of evaluations*. ~~The rating of a player cannot go down (i.e. have a less-skilled rating) but it can go up (a more skilled rating) if the player is found to consistently have too great an impact.~~

As guidance, players who have registered as a Sub-Only player should have *preference* over rostered players when a sub is needed, and managers ***are expected*** ~~should attempt~~ to use a Sub-Only player whenever possible.

The Sub Coordinator has the authority to ***lower (i.e more skilled)*** ~~adjust~~ the rating of any player that is consistently playing significantly "above" other players drafted in the same round. For a drafted player, the revised rating shall only apply to that player when asked to substitute. The rating of a ***drafted*** player ***may*** ~~will~~ not be ***increased (i.e. less skilled)*** ~~adjusted if he does not perform up to the expectations at the time of his drafted position~~ but could be ***increased*** ~~re-rate down~~ for a SUB-ONLY player ~~if he is not being used or displays a lapse in ability that resulted in him being Sub-Only~~ after board approval.

Sub-Only players and team managers should use The Villages Softball Division 1 Sub Player Coordination website at http://sites.google.com/view.tvd1subs to facilitate the sub player process.

Sub-Only players should regularly check their availability on the website and submit requests as needed to update it whenever their schedule changes. Requests for changes should be submitted via the website.

Team managers should review the website regularly to ensure it accurately reflects the status of their substitute players. Requests for changes should be submitted via the website.

Team managers are expected to Verify Subs on the website the day before each game after confirming that the Game Day Summary accurately lists their substitutes for the next day.

NOTE: It is the responsibility of each team manager to submit a timely request for any Game Day Substitute player changes. Once a substitute player has been reflected on the website for a team more than 24 hours following the game in which they were a substitute, that substitution will become permanent and may not be modified.

Regular Season

LEAGUE SUBSTITUTION GUIDE

Player Being Replaced	***Who Can Substitute***
Round 1 Player	***Any drafted or Sub-Only player***
Round 2 Player	***Any player drafted round 2-11 or Sub-Only player rated 2-11***
Round 3 Player	***Any player drafted round 3–11 or Sub-Only player rated 3-11***
Round 4–5 Player	***Any player drafted round 4–11 or Sub-Only player rated 4-11***
Round 6–7 Player	***Any player drafted round 6–11 or Sub-Only player rated 6-11***
Round 8–9 Player	***Any player drafted round 8–11 or Sub-Only player rated 8-11***
Round 10–11 Player	***Any player drafted round 10–11 or Sub-Only player rated 10-11***

Substitution Limits

Players drafted in rounds 1-9 and Sub-Only players rated 1-9 may only substitute up to 2 times per team during the regular season.

Players drafted in rounds 10–11 and Sub-Only players rated 10-11 may substitute for any team unlimited times.

~~Round 1 Player: A Round 1 Player is anyone drafted in the first round or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 1 Player. Any player drafted or on the Sub-Only list may substitute for a Round 1 Player. *A Round 1 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.*~~

~~Round 2 Player: A Round 2 Player is anyone drafted in the second round. Any player drafted in round 2 (or lower) or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 2 Player (or lower) may substitute for a Round 2 Player. A Round 2 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.~~

~~*Round 3-Player: A Round 3 Player is anyone drafted in the third round. Any player drafted in round 3 (or lower) or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 3 Player (or lower) may substitute for a Round 3 Player. A Round 3 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.*~~

~~*Round 4-5 Player: A Round 4 - 5 Player is anyone drafted in the fourth or fifth round. Any player drafted in round 4 (or lower) or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 4 - 5 Player (or lower) may substitute for a Round 4-5 Player. A Round 4 - 5 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.*~~

~~*Round 6-7 Player: A Round 6 - 7 Player is anyone drafted in the sixth or seventh round. Any player drafted in round 6 (or lower) or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 6 - 7 Player (or lower) may substitute for a Round 6 - 7 Player. A Round 6 - 7 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.*~~

~~*Round 8-9 Player: A Round 8 - 9 Player is anyone drafted in the eighth or ninth round. Any player drafted in round 8 (or lower) or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 8 - 9 Player (or lower) may substitute for a Round 8 – 9 Player. A Round 8 - 9 Player may substitute up to two times for a team during the regular season.*~~

~~*Round 10-11 Player: A Round 10 - 11 Player is anyone drafted in the tenth or eleventh round. Any player drafted in round 10 - 11 or on the Sub-Only list as a Round 10 - 11 Player may substitute for a Round 10 - 11 Player. A Round 10 - 11 Player can sub for anyone as many times as needed in any round.*~~

Game Day Substitute Players

~~In the event a substitute is needed prior to the first pitch and a comparably rated substitute is not available, a lower rated substitute may start the game and be replaced with a comparably rated substitute player,~~

After the 1st pitch has been thrown, ~~Per Division One rules,~~ a rostered player ***which has been replaced*** ~~that is not available at the start of a game~~ CANNOT enter the game if a substitute player has been obtained. ~~A substitute player obtained before the first pitch has been thrown will be recorded as a substitute for that team. The manager responsible for notifying the Substitute Player Coordinator.~~

In the event a substitute player ~~must~~ enter***s*** the game ~~after the 1st pitch has been thrown, but~~ before the player to be replaced has had 1 complete at bat, and played 3 outs in the field, that substitute shall be counted as a substitute player used by that team. A substitute entering the game after this point will not be counted against the teams substitutes use. ***The manager must submit a sub request for any qualifying game day substitutes to the Sub Coordinator before the end of the day.***

If a manager is found to be abusing the "Game Day Substitute Players" rules, the Sub~~stitute Player~~ Coordinator may impose a penalty where the***ir*** team will be required to use a player from the next lowest category for "*ALL*" of their substitute players the next game any substitute is utilized.

Post Season

The following will apply only to the Post-Season ***Playoffs.*** ~~Tournament:~~

1. Sub-Only players are not available for ***use.*** ~~the playoffs.~~

2***. For players drafted in rounds 1 – 9, a substitute must come from at least one round later.*** ~~**lower** than the player being subbed for in rounds 1 – 9.~~

For Example:

Player Being Replaced	***Who Can Substitute***
Round 1 Player	***Player drafted round 2+***
Round 2 Player	***Player drafted round 3+***
Round 3 Player	***Player drafted round 4+***

~~Round 1 Roster Player: Sub from Round 2 or lower~~
~~Round 2 Roster Player: Sub from Round 3 or lower~~
~~*Round 3 Roster Player. Sub from Round 4 or lower*~~

3. Rounds 10 & 11 ***players*** can substitute for anyone~~, including a 10 for an 11~~.

4. No ~~Substitute Player~~ player shall play for a team more than ***once as a substitute player throughout the playoffs.*** ~~one day of the tournament, unless two games are scheduled for a team on the same day, and one ultimately gets postponed to another day, then the team can use the same sub(s).~~

5. No ~~Substitute Player~~ player shall play for 2 different teams on the same day as a Substitute Player.